

Facial recognition

Windows 8 reportedly will have an advanced form of facial recognition that will log in users before they even get a chance to sit down after turning on the PC

Push button reset

The idea of this function is to allow the user to reinstall Windows while maintaining all personal files, applications and settings without taking a manual backup - something that we all were



Windows 8 machine specifications

used to doing some time back with Norton Ghost. As reported on the Msft-kitchen blog the slide deck describes a scenario where a user notices his system starts to perform poorly. Why it should perform poorly over time is



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something Windows should solve but anyway it offers this reset function as a solution.

Digit's top 8 for Windows 8

From what we've seen so far, Microsoft certainly has some new tricks up its sleeve. But lets forget the 'brain-melting-super-secret-mindblowing-leaked-slides' for a second and look at what you and I as common end users would like from our OS of choice.

Firefox as the default browser

We're of course kidding, but it's an indicator of how IE is hated by the geekier lot. You can however stop dreaming since a large number of these slides talk of IE9. What's new with IE 9 then you ask? Nothing much really,

except your standard GPU-powered HTML5 graphics capability which Firefox is already offering.

Tighter Web Integration for social networking

Interestingly, the latest Ubuntu version has managed this quite well. Windows on the other hand has integration limited to their Live service. What we're talking about is simple - you log into the user account for the OS and you're automatically logged into all your social networks and IMs right from one panel as part of the OS not as a third party app. Imagine what you could do with photos and other stuff on your system and simple contextual menus. Your right-click send to option could allow you to post stuff where ever you want anywhere.

Touch shell option for transforming it to a tablet OS

Even when reviewing HP's TouchSmart line of PCs last year, we came to a forlorn conclusion - Desktop OSes cannot be made to work as touch screen OSes simply by adding touch functionality and a touch screen. Finger input needs a different interface design - big buttons, a minimalist look, etc are needed. A touch shell or different UI operating over the normal desktop OS is one possible solution. With netbooks with detachable screens being spotted lately, the possibilities are limitless in terms of using



Win 8 plans to focus on 3 form factors

tablets as mobile computing as well as desktop devices. A touch shell could make a device multi-form. A slide describing three separate form factors (Slate, Laptop, and All-in-One) makes us believe Microsoft might just be thinking in that direction.

More Windows 7 less Vista

We're talking about further tweaks to the UAC (User Account Control) and

other stuff that Windows 7 managed quite well. The Superbar for instance with its applications pinning was a great step up and a move towards merging functionality that the Mac Dock provides.

Starter edition of office bundled

Lets face it - If there's one thing Microsoft is good at, it's their Office suite. When customers pay for an operating system why is it unreasonable to expect it to help you get by in the most common use cases? Simple work processing and spreadsheet creation is a much needed feature any modern day OS should allow.

Cloud

One of the other interesting possibilities revealed in the slides was user accounts connected to the cloud which would allow your preferences to be accessed from anywhere. A shift from machine centric to user centric computing. Perhaps mounting Microsoft's own cloud storage would be a good idea considering bandwidth improvements in the future.

Faster start up - hallelujah !

Yea sure some of you might be using hibernate, in which case your PC wakes up quicker. But the rest of us mortals go through the excruciating wait time associated with a windows boot. Yes even with Windows 7. Three slides dedicated to address this issue is an encouraging sign. "Windows 8 PCs turn on fast, nearly instantly in some cases, and are ready to work without any long or unexpected delays. When customers want to check email, sports scores, or play media they love to reach for their PCs because they can get what they want quickly." No kidding Windows.

More eyecandy

Some of the rumours suggest that Windows 8 will natively support 3D. That means apart from stereoscopic movies and pictures maybe your desktop itself will be three dimensional. The techradar blog talks of as-yet-undetermined 3D video codecs. A slide showing the regular Media Center sporting a 3D movie collection is another indicator. 